



Phase 6 | Suffixes
Non-Fiction | Reader 9

Focus Suffix | **-est**



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9 -est

The Wheel



Written By Anna Kirschberg



Phase 6 - Suffixes

-s and -es	-ing	-ed
-er	-est	un-

-est Suffixes

est	Drop	Nothing
greatest	earliest *	greatest
earliest	heaviest *	
heaviest	* Change y to i and add est	

Teachers / Parents

These readers have been written with rich vocabulary including embedded words that contain suffixes. Discuss the use of suffixes for changing the meaning of words and the spelling rules applied. The text consolidates earlier taught phonics skills and heart words.

Phase Six - Non-Fiction (Discoveries & Inventions)

1. The Power of X-Rays
2. The History of Vaccines
3. Inventing the Telephone
4. Inventing the Lightbulb
5. Marie Curie
6. Devoted to the Soil
7. Stem Cell Research
8. Josephine's Dishwasher
9. The Wheel
10. Discovering Genetics
11. The Computer Programmer
12. Central Heating Systems

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The Wheel

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Today, wheels are everywhere. You can find wheels in cars, airplanes, wheelchairs, bicycles, trains, caravans, and even roller skates. The wheel could be one of the greatest inventions of all time.

The wheel





Was the wheel one of the greatest inventions that changed the course of history? Possibly, it was. Without the invention of the wheel, the world's work might have to stop.



Spoked wheels were composed of three key parts – the hub, the spokes and a rim. This type of wheel appeared in the Egyptian chariots, around 2000 BC. The Ancient Romans went on to develop variety in their wheeled vehicles. They built farm carts, chariots for war, hunting and racing, and even passenger coaches.



The first wheels would have been solid discs or sliced tree trunks. Spoked wheels were soon to follow. Spoked wheels allowed swifter and lighter vehicles to be constructed.



Think about what wheels are used for every day; in cars, trains, farm machines, and airplanes. We might still have to carry our heaviest loads on the backs of animals to get around, if we did not have the use of wheels.



The wheel is a simple machine. It is a circle-shaped device that allows things to roll. As the wheel spins, the objects on the wheel move along the ground.



We do not know exactly when wheels were invented. Some of the earliest evidence for the wheel dates back to 4000 BC in Mesopotamia, where wheels on a form of turntable were used for making pottery. Evidence for the earliest wheeled vehicles sits somewhere around 3500 BC. Before this, sleds or sledges with rollers were used to move large objects across the land.